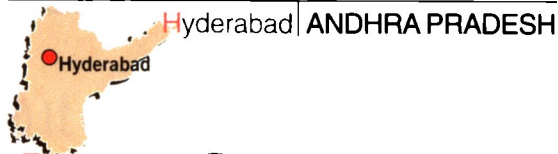


IT IN AGRICULTURE



A plot of his own

■ By Amarnath K. Menon

Kasala Rajaiah, 58, owns five acres of land on which he grows maize and ribbed gourd. Now, it is in three holds in Babaguda village in the northern suburbs of Hyderabad but he wants to consolidate them into one plot which would be easier to cultivate. What has made his task easier is the ease of verification of land records and registry under the Andhra Pradesh Government's e-governance system, which involves using computers for registry of land. Referred to as CARD, which stands

The Government's computerised registration system helps villagers consolidate land holdings

for Computer-Aided Administration of Registration Department, this initiative has radically changed the way the sub-registrar's offices (SROs) throughout the state deal with registry of land. At any of the 387 SROs, a citizen can register a document for a nominal fee, provided it pertains to the geographical domain of that office.

"Now, I can present the papers, go shopping to the local market and return after four hours to collect the final document and go home. Earlier, when registry was done manually, I had to make at least two trips, with a break of three to four days, to get a sale deed registered," points out Nalari Sattaiah, a 55-year-old, unlettered villager who is in the process of consolidating his five pieces of land. He, or for that matter any other buyer or seller, can now verify the ownership of the land to be

■ RS 1,000 CRORE: IS THE BUDGET SET ASIDE BY THE UNION GOVERNMENT FOR INDIA'S E-GOVERNANCE PROJECT.

■ 2000: THE NUMBER OF CITIZEN SERVICE KIOSKS UNDER THE SCHEME IN ANDHRA PRADESH.

bought by applying for an encumbrance certificate that gives all the necessary information. With the introduction of CARD, the certificate can be obtained in a couple of hours. Under the manual system, it used to take a week. CARD has made access to records simpler, making life easier for villagers like Rajaiah and Sattaiah.



CHANGE AT LAST: Kasala Rajaiah

A PRABHAKAR RAO



TECH ON THE GO: Sahana Shetty at a mobile ATM

SHRIYA PATIL

NEW-AGE BANKING



Easy money

No more long queues and cranky clerks. Banking is now an anytime, anywhere service thanks to multi-tasking ATMs.

■ By Malini Bhupta

Sahana Shetty, 28-year-old sales manager with Kotak Life Insurance, cannot remember when she last walked into her bank's branch, be it for withdrawing money or collecting a cheque book. When she needs to withdraw money, she goes to the nearest ATM. For all other banking needs, she merely has to press the right buttons on her cell phone. Less than 10 years ago, banking in India meant a trip to a dreary bank branch and an endless wait in a long queue at the cash counter. Fast forward to 2007 and the sweaty waits and attendants with attitude have been replaced by customer-friendly ATMs, which do a lot more than spew cash. Whether it is booking airline or movie tickets, or